

Alex Alvord

Advisory Solutions Architect, Hybrid Multicloud · AI infrastructure & agentic systems

Duvall, Washington · Pacific Northwest, remote-first

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PROFILE

Solutions architect who puts AI systems into real infrastructure and explains them to the people who have to run and pay for them. Twenty years on both sides of the table: seven as a finance and operations controller, thirteen designing, selling and running cloud, OpenStack and bare metal, the three hyperscalers, and since 2019 Nutanix hybrid multicloud, on NC2 from a fifteen-person incubation team to 250. Since 2025, hands-on with production agentic systems: a multi-agent operations stack with harnesses, tool policy, memory and local inference, run daily from a home lab and published as Cloud Lab Works, a place to collaborate live on projects, on his own time and equipment. Every design is grounded in what it costs to operate, GPUs included.

SELECTED WORK

Agentic operations stack: Cloud Lab Works

2025 – present

github.com/issaquahd · Invisible Wires — Agentic Cloud

- Multi-agent system on OpenClaw with a principal agent, sub-agents and a family agent; three model lanes routed by task (hosted frontier models by subscription and API, local Qwen via Ollama), each kind of work pinned to a lane with no silent fallback.
- File-backed identity and memory in git; semantic memory with local embeddings (nomic-embed-text) and no egress; prompt-injection defenses (untrusted-content markers, paired senders, memory-less inbound agents); secrets that never enter model context (egress-proxy sentinels, vault-only credentials, CDP-side injection).
- Agents that run infrastructure: Cloudflare Workers + Zero Trust across three domains deployed by agent, scheduled sentinels for site health, a post-to-email pipeline, and Infrastructure as Music (lab state rendered as a live instrument).
- Governance as code: a constitution with gated vs. ungated action classes, prompt-budget limits with soft ceilings, a control ledger, and a persona prompt budget enforced at build time.

NC2 on AWS, as code

2026

Nutanix Notes · v4 APIs, OpenTofu, Flow Virtual Networking

- End-to-end walkthrough from the NC2 console to the first VM with every block verified against the provider; the pattern used in customer PoCs and lab sessions.

WHY THESE COMPANIES

A career is a sequence of bets on where infrastructure was going. These were the bets.

RightScale (2013): early to cloud when "cloud" still meant one vendor. RightScale's thesis was that orchestrating resources through APIs would matter more than owning them: multi-cloud management, ServerTemplates, automation across AWS, Azure, SoftLayer, Rackspace and Google Compute Engine years before "multicloud" was a category. Its co-founder and CTO, Thorsten von Eicken, had been a Cornell computer-science professor who co-authored the U-Net work with Werner Vogels, later Amazon's CTO. Working the AWS alliance from inside that company was a front-row seat to the API-first, orchestrate-don't-own model everything since has been built on.

Smartsheet (2014): SaaS at enterprise scale before it was assumed: rollouts from 2,000 to 200,000 seats, API partners as the growth channel, SSO and governance as the buying criteria. The playbook for how software actually lands in a large company.

Internap / INAP (2015 – 2018): a monster in networking: a global backbone with route-optimized transit and high-density data centers, plus OpenStack, bare-metal cloud and colocation on top. It is where Layer 2–7, peering, latency and the physical substrate under "the cloud" became first-hand knowledge, the part most cloud architects never touch.

Rubrik (2018 – 2019): the data layer reinvented as a cloud-native, API-first platform: backup, recovery, replication and search as one distributed system with an open API, at the moment ransomware made data management a board-level problem. Field CTO for the channel there meant teaching the ecosystem how orchestration and Open APIs change operations.

Nutanix (2019 –): the hybrid multicloud bet made real: the same platform on-prem and in AWS, Azure and Google Cloud, with NC2 taken from a fifteen-person incubation team to a 250-person organization. The v4 APIs, Flow Virtual Networking and infrastructure-as-code on top of it are the current chapter; AI infrastructure, GPUs, storage and the cost model next to the data, is the next one.

EXPERIENCE

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SKILLS

AGENTIC & AI INFRASTRUCTURE

- Multi-agent orchestration
- Agent harnesses & tool policy
- LLM APIs (Anthropic, OpenAI-compatible)
- Model routing · hosted + local
- MCP tool integration
- Memory engines · embeddings · RAG
- Local inference (Ollama)
- Prompt-injection defense
- Sandboxed execution
- Evals & verification gates
- GPU/AI substrate sizing
- Inference cost modelling

HYBRID MULTICLOUD

- Nutanix NC2 · AWS · Azure · GCP
- Prism Central · v4 APIs
- Flow Virtual Networking · OpenStack
- VMware · KVM · Hyper-V · AHV
- Datacenter divestment · L2 stretch
- DR · Multicloud Snapshot

CLOUD NATIVE & IAC

- OpenTofu / Terraform · Ansible
- Kubernetes · Containers · GitOps
- Cloudflare Workers · Zero Trust
- Proxmox · CI/CD

BUSINESS

- FinOps · TCO / ROI · Cloud economics
- PoC / PoV design
- Partner & channel enablement
- Insight Selling · Financial forecasting
- Public speaking · labs

HONORS

FY24 Americas Portfolio Solutions Architect of the Year, Nutanix

Solutions Architect of the Quarter: Q4 2022, Q2 2023, Q4 2024, Q1 2025, Q3 2026

Authority Magazine interview on digital transformation, Dec 2025

INAP President's Club 2015 – 2017

Seattle Nutanix User Group: founder, 2020

CERTIFICATIONS

Nutanix

2019 – present

Seattle, WA · Americas Solutions Architecture, Hybrid Multicloud

Advisory Solutions Architect, Hybrid Multicloud (2023 –) · Hybrid Multicloud SME (2021 – 2023) · Sr. Systems Engineer (2020 – 2021) · Systems Engineer (2019 – 2020)

- Subject-matter expert for Nutanix Cloud Clusters (NC2) on AWS, Azure and Google Cloud, from the incubation team to a 250-person organization; owns the NC2 on AWS lab sessions at Global Tech Summit since 2023 and presents on the XTour since 2022.
- Runs the field motion end to end: PoC/PoV, multi-phase migration journeys, FinOps and TCO/ROI, solution demos, and partner and channel enablement across the Americas.
- AI infrastructure engineering for customers moving models next to their data: GPU node sizing, storage and network substrate, and the cost model that decides on-prem vs. cloud for inference and fine-tuning.
- Built the "Commercial TCO/ROI light" that any AE/SE can run in front of a customer; trained partners and account teams on it; a core differentiator that shortened time to purchase.
- First Commercial SE hired in the Pacific Northwest; supported WA, OR, ID and AK, closed the largest Oregon Commercial and Alaska deals of the time, and onboarded every Commercial AE in the region. Mentored four Systems Engineers directly.
- Founder and champion sponsor of the Seattle Nutanix User Group (2020 –); founded the Anchorage NUG (2020 – 2022).

Cloud Lab Works LLC

2026 – present

Duvall, WA · Principal · working lab and open collaboration on projects

- A working lab and a place to collaborate live on projects (not a consultancy): agentic operations, AI infrastructure sizing (GPU, storage and network substrate), open-source repos, technical writing, speaking and mentoring. Own time, own equipment, public information only.
- Runs the lab as a product: M4 Pro inference host, Proxmox sandbox tier, Tailscale subnet routing, Cloudflare edge; everything with an owner, a health check and a place in git.
- Writes *Invisible Wires* — *Agentic Cloud* and *Nutanix Notes*; sixty-plus conference-years of field work since 2011, staff on site at re:Invent, Ignite and Google Cloud Next.

Rubrik

2018 – 2019

Seattle, WA · Systems Engineer · Field CTO for the Pacific Northwest channel

- Technical lead for cloud data management across hybrid and multicloud, Open API integrations, SaaS (O365), orchestrated DR and ransomware analytics.
- Enabled the channel (VARs, LARs, SIs, consultancies) through instructor-led sessions, QBRs and the LMS; drove the ecosystem: ServiceNow/ITSM, Ansible, Chef, Puppet, SaltStack, containers, HashiCorp.
- 2018 quota attainment: 175% Q1, 210% Q2, 195% Q3, 220% Q4.

Internap (INAP)

2015 – 2018

Seattle, WA · Cloud Solutions Architect

- Owned technical feasibility and design for large hybrid solutions: OpenStack, bare-metal cloud, VMware, Hyper-V and KVM private cloud, colocation, managed hosting, Layer 2–7 networking and compliance.
- Migration strategy, interoperability, orchestration and API management across OpenStack, AWS, Azure and Google Cloud; Equinix Cloud Exchange hybrid designs.
- Trained partner SE communities at AWS, Azure, VMware, New Relic, NGINX, OpenStack, NetApp and Aerospike; ran the labs and wrote the whitepapers and case studies. President's Club 2015, 2016, 2017 (top 5% revenue attainment).

Smartsheet

2014

Bellevue, WA · Strategic Accounts (technical + sales)

- Enterprise-wide SaaS rollouts from beachhead to site license for organizations of 2,000 to 200,000 seats; co-selling with API partners; scope covered Open APIs, compliance, security, governance and SSO. Completed M3 Proactive Selling with its author.

RightScale

2013

Seattle, WA · Technical Account Manager

- Partner alliances with AWS, Azure, IBM SoftLayer, Rackspace and Google Compute Engine; ran the AWS west-coast joint enablement cadence: leads up 310%, close rate up 23%, sales cycle 19 days shorter.
- Multi-cloud PoCs on the RightScale platform: portability via orchestration and automation; a multi-cloud Open API Wi-Fi framework for what became South America's largest airline group.

Zones

2007 – 2013

Seattle, WA · Enterprise Solutions Architect, Export Center

AWS Solutions Architect – Professional; Solutions Architect – Associate; Cloud Practitioner

Microsoft Azure Solutions Architect Expert; Azure Administrator; Azure Fundamentals

Google Cloud Professional Cloud Architect

Nutanix NCP – Multicloud Infrastructure; NCP – Multicloud Automation; NCP – SME; NCSE I & II

Kubernetes Administrator

Also IBM Certified Cloud Computing Advisor; EMC Cloud Infrastructure & Services; Rackspace uCloud; Red Hat partner (platform, middleware, virtualization); VMware, Citrix, Cisco, Juniper, NetApp, Oracle sales and technical tracks; Sandler Training

COMMUNITY

OpenStack foundation member (2011); CNCF (2015); SNIA technical council (2025); Cloud Security Alliance CxO Trust WG; FinOps Foundation; FINOS; ONUG

Mentor: PLU Econ Mentoring Program (2016 –), National Society of Sales Engineers, Technology Access Foundation

Full list: cloudlabworks.dev/#volunteering

LANGUAGES

English · Mandarin Chinese (eight years of study; lived in China)

- Complex solutions for strategic and large enterprise accounts (cloud, HPC, networking, analytics) with project management through delivery. Top 1% in revenue and margin; employee of the quarter three times.
- Certified Zones to sell enterprise technologies it had not been authorized for (public cloud, JD Edwards); "Insight Selling" cut the net-new sales cycle to 36 days.

Earlier

2001 – 2007

The HN BBPIL LLC, Seattle: Controller, Finance & Operations (2001 – 2007) · Invisible Wires Inc., Seattle: Project Manager, Business Analytics (2005)

- Ran finance and operations reporting to the executive team: forecasting, asset management, cost control; redesigned operations for a 22% year-over-year margin gain and double-digit revenue growth; brokered the company's sale and led through the acquisition.
- Launched a SaaS analytics stack integrated with POS and CRM: real-time view of customer behaviour and variable cost, double-digit reduction in variable costs. The name lives on as the blog.

EDUCATION

Pacific Lutheran University

2001 – 2006

Bachelor of Business Administration, Information Technology Management · AACSB-accredited

University of Washington

2013 – 2014

Cloud Data Management & Analytics

Peking University, Beijing

2001

Mandarin Chinese

This is the living résumé; it changes as the work does. © Alex Alvord.